TOP SECRET · YOUR EYES ONLY

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE HQ

DETECTIVE (yes, you):

CLASSIFIED

You have been selected. This classroom is now Detective HQ. There is a **MYSTERY** to solve, and you are on the case.

Your questions, answered:

1. What is the mystery? **CLASSIFIED.**
2. Who is involved? **CLASSIFIED.**
3. What will you need? Sharp eyes. A good memory. A codename.

That is all we can put on paper. Paper gets read by the wrong people. Before your first assignment, you train. Three tests. Pencil only.

TEST 1 · CRACK IT. A=1, B=2, C=3 … Z=26. ONE LETTER PER LINE.

8 1 16 16 25 8 1 12 12 15 23 5 5 14

_____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

TEST 2 · LEAVE YOUR MARK.

Scribble the gray box black with your pencil. Rub your thumb in it. Press your thumb in the white box, flat, no wiggling. That is your fingerprint. No two detectives on Earth have the same one. Keep it; HQ may need it.



TEST 3 · BECOME SOMEONE ELSE.

Pick a codename. Write it on the Detective ID you were just handed, then fill in the rest. The color of your ID is your squad. Learn your squad number. Guard the ID.

Passed all three? Good. You're in. Until the briefing, say nothing.

BRIEFING Friday, October 30, 1:30 PM. Right here.

WEAR your costume and your ID. The best detectives work undercover.

TELL **NOBODY.** Not even older siblings. They crack under pressure.

— Agent Shadow
(Real name: classified.)

MISSION ACCEPTED. Sign your codename:

_____

Done already? Then you're faster than most. Fast is good. Careful is better. Two more tests. Pencil only. No talking, except in Test 5, and only in code.

TEST 4 · THE ROOM TEST

Do not look up. Seriously. Eyes on this page.

A detective notices everything, even things nobody asked about. Answer from memory. Then look up and check.

1. How many windows are in this room? _____
2. What color is the classroom door? _____
3. Is there a clock? What time does it say? _____
4. Name something on the Chief's desk. _____
5. What is on the board right now? _____
6. Shoes on the person to your left: what color? _____

6 right: Eagle Eye. **4–5:** Sharp. **2–3:** Promising. **0–1:** You would walk past a dinosaur.

TEST 5 · SEND A CODED MESSAGE

Write a message in numbers. Trade with another finished detective. Crack theirs.

Rules: numbers only, a dash between letters, a gap between words. Keep it kind. No real names; codenames are fine.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

YOUR MESSAGE (IN NUMBERS)

_____

_____

THE MESSAGE YOU CRACKED (IN LETTERS)

_____

_____

— Agent Shadow
(Still classified.)

Both done? Sit tight. Say nothing. Look innocent.